Brad called me to tell me he liked the additional chapters of The Stars, like Dust—, and I felt expansive enough to take all the Bluger-mans to a shore dinner at Lundi's, where we wreaked havoc on the lobster, chicken, and steamed clams. The whole bill came to $24, but I had come a long way since $10 had scared me silly at Locke-Ober's.

And on June 11, we were back in Somerville.

In Somerville, Gertrude was still uncertain as to her next step with regard to the driving lessons. I suggested that she take it easy for a while and that I would take driving lessons. That would give us two chances, and if either of us made it, we could get a car. Then, too, she could wait till after I had taken my test, pass or fail, before she would have to decide whether to take the test herself or to take additional lessons. In all this I put on a show of confidence I did not feel.

Beyond Campbell rg?

On June 12, then, I took my first driving lesson and, as it happened, one of the first-year medical students, whom I had just finished teaching biochemistry, was making some odd change by teaching at a driving school and he was to teach me. This meant I could rely on patience and intelligence, and it eased my fears.

He got me in the car and showed me how to turn on the engine after making sure the car was in neutral. Then he had me step on the clutch and put the car in reverse. Then he told me to let the clutch come up slowly and just let the car move a few feet and then step on the brake.

I did as he said and as the car began to move, a very peculiar and utterly unforeseen thing happened to me: I found that I loved the sensation; that I felt in control. The next day, I was actually driving, shifting gears, and turning corners. I continued to love it. By the third day,

1 was determined to buy a car as soon as possible.

Why that should be I don't know, but I have loved to drive ever since. It is the only way in which I really enjoy getting from here to there (aside from walking).

On June 17, we were shopping for a car and looking at Plymouths. Then we went to Durgin-Park for a farewell dinner with the Bersons, who had, by a pleasant coincidence, also spent 1949-50 in Boston. Now, however, Jerry